LEVANTE DEMO REALTY

FOR BUYERS

The First-Time Buyer's Guide

A calm, step by step plan from first budget to getting the keys

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WELCOME

Buying a home is one of the biggest decisions you will make, and it is much easier with a plan. This guide walks through the journey in the order it happens, so you always know what comes next and what to ask.

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CHAPTER 1

Know your budget

Start with what you can comfortably afford, not the largest figure a lender would offer. Your budget has three parts: the money you have ready, the monthly amount you can sustain, and a cushion for the unexpected.

Costs beyond the price

- Deposit and any financing arrangement fees
- Transfer, registration and agent fees that apply where you buy
- Valuation, survey or inspection costs
- Moving, furnishing and first-month running costs

> **RULE OF THUMB**
>
> Add up every one-off cost before you fall in love with a property. Surprises at the end of the process are the most common reason a purchase falls apart.

CHAPTER 2

How the process works

Every market has its own paperwork, but the sequence is similar almost everywhere. Knowing the shape of it removes most of the stress.

- Decide your budget and your must-haves
- Get financing in principle if you need it
- Search, shortlist and view
- Make an offer and agree the terms
- Complete the legal checks and sign
- Pay, register and collect the keys

Ask your agent to explain which of these steps are handled by an authority, which by a lawyer and which by you, so nothing is left to chance.

CHAPTER 3

Viewing day checklist

Photos are made to flatter. A viewing is your chance to check everything a photo cannot show. Take this list with you and tick as you go.

- [ ] Natural light at the time of day you will be home
- [ ] Water pressure, taps and signs of damp
- [ ] Noise from the street, neighbours and building systems
- [ ] Storage, layout and where your furniture will go
- [ ] Parking, lifts, deliveries and building rules
- [ ] The journey to work, school and daily shops

CHAPTER 4

Making your offer

An offer is more than a number. Terms such as timing, what is included and conditions can matter as much as the price.

- Compare with similar recent sales, not only asking prices
- Decide your walk-away figure before you negotiate
- Put every condition in writing
- Agree who pays which fees

> **ASK YOUR ADVISOR**
>
> A good agent will show you the evidence behind a price. If you are unsure, ask for comparable properties and how long they took to sell.

NEXT STEP

Talk it through with an advisor

Book a free, no-obligation conversation. We will review your budget, shortlist areas that fit and explain the next steps for your situation.

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This guide is general information and is not legal, tax or financial advice. Rules and fees differ by location and change over time, so check current requirements with the relevant authority or a qualified professional before you act.